RIFAT ERDEM SAHIN

PRODUCT OWNER | AGILE PRODUCT MANAGEMENT SPECIALIST

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🌐 **Portfolio:** https://rifaterdemsahin.com
📅 **Schedule a Call:** https://calendly.com/rifaterdem/schedule

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Certified Product Owner specializing in **backlog management, stakeholder alignment, and maximizing product value**. Deep expertise in translating business vision into actionable user stories and acceptance criteria. Proven track record in working closely with engineering teams to deliver high-quality software features iteratively and on schedule.

CORE COMPETENCIES

📦 **Product Ownership** - Backlog Grooming & Prioritization - User Story Writing & Acceptance Criteria (BDD) - Roadmap Planning & Release Management - Stakeholder Management & Communication

🔍 **Product Discovery** - User Research & Persona Definition - MVP Definition & Scope Management - Data-Driven Decision Making - Competitor Analysis

KEY ACCOMPLISHMENTS

🏆 2026 – Present | Delivery Pilot — Skool Platform

AI Professional Transformation & Forward Deployed Engineering Mentorship - Mentoring engineers and technology professionals to transition into AI Engineers and Forward Deployed Engineers (FDE) by closing practical and technical skill gaps. - Designing and delivering hands-on curriculum on the Skool Platform covering AI-augmented engineering, RAG architectures, multi-LLM orchestration, agentic workflows (n8n, MCP), and GitOps delivery. - Guiding cohort members through building, evaluating, and deploying production-grade AI applications and cloud-native integrations. - **Technologies:** Anthropic Claude, OpenAI, RAG, Qdrant, n8n, LangChain, Kubernetes, Docker, Python, Skool Platform

2024 | EdTech Platform | London

Learning Management System Revamp - **Challenge:** Modernize the student dashboard to improve course completion rates. - **Solution:** Led the product squad to iteratively release a gamified dashboard based on user feedback. - **Impact:** - Increased course completion rates by 15%. - Achieved a Net Promoter Score (NPS) increase of 10 points. - Delivered the project on time and under budget.

2023 | Retail App | Remote

Mobile Checkout Optimization - **Challenge:** High drop-off rate at the payment stage of the mobile app. - **Solution:** Prioritized Apple/Google Pay integration and streamlined the guest checkout flow. - **Impact:** - Reduced checkout time by 90 seconds. - Increased mobile conversion rate by 8%. - Generated an estimated £500k incremental revenue annually.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE HIGHLIGHTS

Founder & Lead AI Mentor / Delivery Pilot | 2026 – Present
Delivery Pilot (Skool Platform) · Remote

- Leading AI engineering mentorship and training on the Skool Platform to help professionals bridge skills gaps and become production-ready Forward Deployed Engineers (FDE)
- Designing curriculum across LLM orchestration, RAG architectures, prompt engineering, agentic workflows, and cloud-native AI delivery
- Conducting hands-on architecture reviews and portfolio project evaluations

Senior Product Owner / AI Solutions Architect | January 2025 – January 2026 *IBM* | *London, UK*

- Architecting hybrid cloud transformation using IBM Cloud and Red Hat OpenShift for Fortune 500 enterprises
- Implementing watsonx AI solutions for intelligent automation, reducing operational overhead by 35%
- Leading DevSecOps transformation with Ansible Automation Platform and Terraform IaC across multi-cloud environments
- Delivering zero-downtime Kubernetes cluster migrations for mission-critical financial and government workloads
- Building enterprise CI/CD pipelines with GitHub Actions and Jenkins serving 500+ developers globally

Senior Product Owner / Technical Lead | 2020 - 2025 *Goldman Sachs, Ypsomed, Cushman & Wakefield*

- Led product owner initiatives across finance, healthcare, and real estate sectors
- Designed and implemented solutions supporting millions of daily transactions
- Established best practices and automated frameworks
- Mentored engineering teams on modern technologies and practices
- Delivered solutions achieving 300% improvement in operational efficiency

Product Owner | 2016 - 2020 *Microsoft, Emerson, Various Fortune 500*

- Built enterprise solutions for digital transformation initiatives
- Led cross-functional teams designing scalable applications
- Established frameworks and implementation strategies
- Evangelized modern technologies through technical leadership

EDUCATION

🎓 **Bachelor of Science**
Southern New Hampshire University, USA 🇺🇸 | 2013

CERTIFICATIONS & CONTINUOUS LEARNING

📜 **Microsoft Certified Solutions Architect Expert**
📜 **AWS Certified Solutions Architect Professional**
📜 **Azure Solutions Architect Expert**
📜 **Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)**

Continuous Learning:
- Active contributor to open-source projects - Regular participant in technical communities - Following latest developments in technology - Experimenting with emerging tools and practices

SECURITY CLEARANCES

🔒 **UK SC (Security Check)** - Valid until 2028
🔒 **NATO Clearance** - Valid until 2029
✓ **Background Checks:** Watchdog (2024), Sterling (2019)

AVAILABILITY & CONTACT

Immediate Availability for product owner roles

📅 **Schedule a Discussion:** https://calendly.com/rifaterdem/schedule
📧 **Email:** contact@rifaterdemsahin.com
📞 **Phone:** +44 7848 024173

SUPPORTING DOCUMENTS

📊 **Technical Portfolio & Presentations:**
https://rifaterdemsahin.com/wp-content/uploads/2025/02/rifaterdemsahinprofilepresentation.v2025.2.pdf

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References and detailed project portfolios available upon request